

Electricity is Dangerous

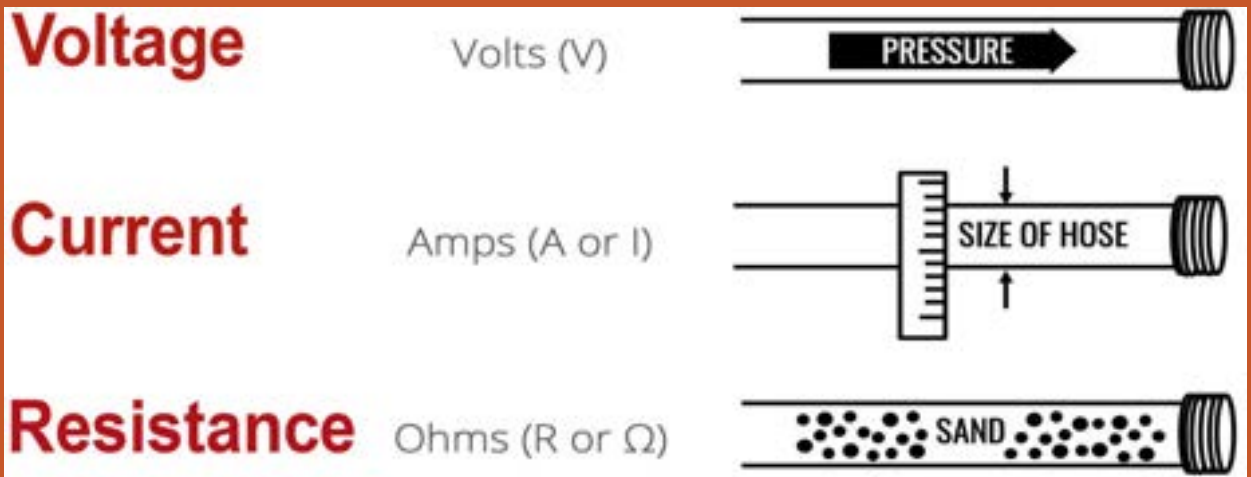


Photo: ARTBA

69% of electrical deaths happen in non-electrically related occupations. 45% nearly half of those occur from striking overhead power lines.¹

Preventing injury or death from electricity begins with understanding how electricity works, identifying the electrical hazards at your work site and then taking steps to reduce the risks of accidental exposure.

Terminology



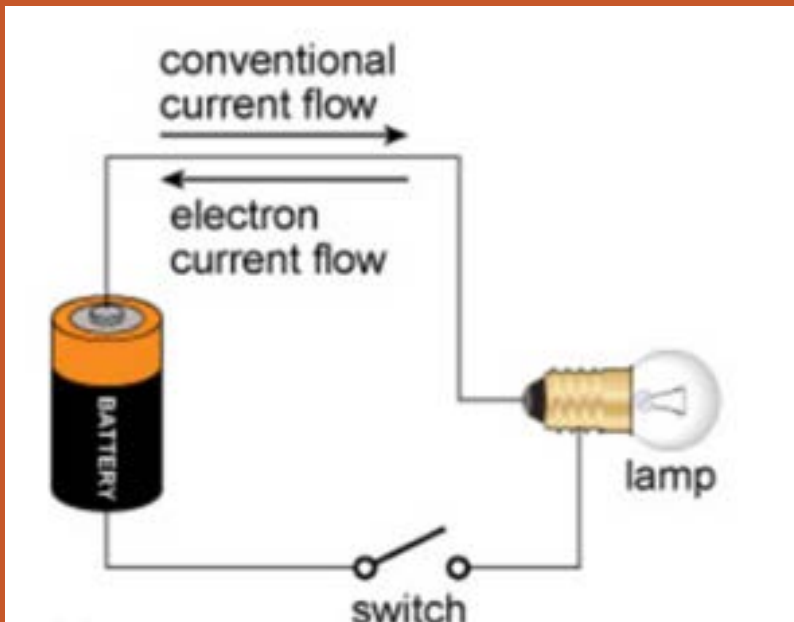
Graphic: Bill Nussey, used with permission

The size of electrical current, measured in **amps**, is like the diameter of a water pipe – the bigger the pipe the more water can flow through it. A thicker wire can carry more current.

Like the water in a pipe, current flows from area of high electrical pressure to lower electrical pressure. The difference between these two pressures is called the voltage and is measured in **volts**.

Anything that interferes with the current is called resistance. Resistance is measured in **ohms**. You can think of resistance as sand inside the pipe partially blocking the flow.

Electrical Current



Electrical current always seeks any available path to an area of lower pressure, completing a **circuit**. In a simple circuit, current flows from an electrical source like a battery or outlet, through an appliance, then back to the electrical source to make a complete path.

